

Turner

The most famous landscape painter of the Romantic movement, the precociously talented J.M.W. Turner (1775–1851) became one of the youngest full members of Britain's Royal Academy of Arts at 27. His early landscapes were influenced by Claude and Dutch painters such as Ruisdael, as well as Joseph Wright of Derby and Poussin, while his later, atmospheric works had a profound effect on many subsequent artists and movements, including Impressionism and Abstract Expressionism. Hugely productive, Turner painted almost incessantly, around Britain and abroad. As his career flourished, he became more innovative, using freer brushwork, sweeping strokes and colours that evoke the light and mood of each scene. With a brilliant palette and original methods, including dissolving shadows and edges, blurring distinctions and unusual compositions, his work was revolutionary for the time. In later life, to ensure his paintings' freshness, he sent unfinished canvases to exhibitions, finishing the painting in the gallery on 'Varnishing Days' before the opening. He became renowned as the 'painter of light'.



Turner, *The Fighting Temeraire Tugged to her Last Berth to be Broken Up*, 1838